

Statement of Purpose

Please use English when filling in this form and write full sentences. However, be specific and keep it short. Please only fill in one form for your two chosen university destinations. Save the file as a pdf document and upload it to the online application form in MoveON.

A) Motivation to go abroad

1.) Please describe up to 3 aspects how a stay abroad would enrich you **academically**?

At first studying abroad would allow me to experience different academic cultures and learning methods from professors and students. My prioritized universities UC San Diego and the Hong Kong University of Science and Technology teach interactive and real-world oriented learning in small classes, which enables close contact to professors. Experiencing this contrast to the studies at TUM would deepen my understanding of how knowledge is transferred and show me ways of learning I could integrate into my studies at TUM. Honestly, I have never had a longer conversation with a professor at TUM. I would love to be able to learn directly, what it feels like to have the privilege and pressure of teaching bright, young minds. I think this would extremely strengthen my mindset towards seeing education as an interplay between students and professors “against” real-world problems, not students “against” professor. A mindset which in my view seems to have emerged in some student’s minds. It would strengthen my ability to think critically through the differences in teaching methods and content, adapt to diverse learning environments amongst other students, and connect theoretical frameworks from TUM with practical, real-world contexts.

Secondly a semester abroad, and at these two universities in particular, would give me the opportunity to take specialized courses that complement my Information System studies at TUM. In both the technical and the management perspective. For example, in fields like machine learning, artificial intelligence and technology in finance. Both UC San Diego and HKUST offer strong interdisciplinary programs that link technology, management and entrepreneurship. Engaging in project-based coursework and collaborating with students from various backgrounds would not only improve my technical knowledge, but also my ability to approach complex business problems from multiple perspectives.

Finally, the two languages English and Chinese will both enrich me in every professional environment. Both California and Hong Kong are global hubs for innovation and technology. One as the birthplace of digital economy and located in the state of Silicon Valley, the other as a gateway to the upcoming economic superpower, Asia. Experiencing such environments firsthand would allow me to see how universities, startups and established companies collaborate to turn research into real world impact. Strengthening my language skills, in either

of the languages, would deeply help me being part of these unique ecosystems and bring them to TUM's ecosystems and my future career.

2.) Please describe up to 3 aspects how a stay abroad would enrich you on a **personal level**?

First, living and studying in a completely new country and continent would challenge me to leave my comfort zone, pushing me to adapt to unfamiliar situations, and build my character no other experience would be able to. From managing my day-to-day life to navigating in the new academic surroundings I would develop a new level of independence. One thing I would love to especially develop is being more confident when approaching strangers. I am super interested in getting to know new people, but often I am too cautious to approach. Being thousands of kilometers away from home, my parents, my brother, my dog and my girlfriend, whom I miss already, knowing no one, I don't have a choice other to approach and get to know other open-minded people, from whom I can learn incredible things.

Furthermore, interacting with students from around the world would allow me to build genuine intercultural competence. At universities like UC San Diego and the Hong Kong University of Science and Technology I would meet peers of a great variety of cultural and academic backgrounds. My experiences as a volunteer language mentor for refugees have already taught me how valuable empathy and communication are when overcoming cultural differences. These are skills I want to strengthen in my semester abroad to also be a more cultural aware and understanding person back in Germany.

At last, a semester abroad would help me to connect and build a network with people who are as passionate about technology, innovation and management as I am. Whether through group projects or student clubs, which I want to be part of in my semester abroad. I hope to make lasting friends and build valuable professional relationships for my entire career. I always remember my father and his best friend, who have met abroad and still are in close contact today. This is what I would love to achieve as well. This would shape me to a more open-minded, curious and globally thinking person. Which in my opinion will be even more crucial in a further and further interconnected world of business and technology.

3.) Which **challenges** could you face during your stay abroad and how would you handle them?

Integrating into a completely new academic and personal environment will bring some challenges, especially in the beginning. Every university, every country and city has its own rhythm and way of life, which I will have to adapt to. To manage this, I plan to attend all introduction events and orientation sessions to meet peers and local students which can help me to integrate. My openness and curiosity will help me adapt quickly and make the most out of my study abroad.

Furthermore, being in a new country of course is also overwhelming, positively speaking. The variety of new events, places and new interesting people to meet can make it challenging to not forget the academic background of the stay. To handle this, I rely on my structured study habits I developed at TUM, where self-studying is the main part of my bachelor's degree. Consistent weekly planning, prioritizing and time blocking are methods I have integrated into my day-to-day life at TUM, which worked really well for me. This will allow me to stay academically on track with my studies, while being able to explore the new culture as well as people and grow personally.

Living abroad, thousands of kilometers from home in a different time zone, with a different climate will be challenging as well. Nevertheless, I already moved several hours away when coming to Munich and have traveled both the US and China which makes me confident, that I am going to handle these challenges and have a great time abroad.

4.) Why did you choose a university in the **United States (first preference)**? Please describe up to 3 aspects that attract you to this country in particular.

In the past years I have been deeply interested in reading books and listening to talks from people like Alex Karp, Warren Buffett and Reid Hoffman, which made the United States and especially California the technological and entrepreneurial epicenter of the world. No other country has influenced the world as much as the US. Even in Germany, our products, our movies, our songs even our way of life and politics are massively influenced by the US, probably more than by every other country. At this moment, while this dynamic seems to be shifting, I would like to understand how the United States is changing or has already changed. How true are the perceived shifts in world order dominated by the US, which are emphasized so heavily in our media? In which state will I experience the United States of America? It remains home to world-leading companies, research institutions and startups, which continuously redefine how technology shapes our lives. Experiencing this environment would allow me to understand how innovation is driven by a unique combination of academic excellence and entrepreneurial spirit. This experimental mindset and permanent improvement perfectly reflect the values I want to integrate into my studies and future career.

Furthermore, the universities in America are known for openness and a strong focus on project-based, hands-on learning in small groups. Studying in such an environment with such a mindset helps me to strengthen abilities like thinking independently and approach problems in teams, complementing the analytical and theoretical knowledge I have gained at TUM.

Lastly, there is probably no other country with a diversity in cultures, backgrounds, ideas and nature like the US. Living and studying in such an environment would allow me to broaden my view of the world and improve my communication skills. California, in particular, stands for openness, ambition and creativity, which would help me for my personal development and give me the opportunity to have a meaningful exchange between students and citizens from all over the world. Beyond San Diego and California, I am eager to visit the great nature,

national parks and cities in the United States, like Yosemite National Park, the Grand Canyon and San Francisco.

5.) Only if your second preference is in a different country: Why did you choose a university in **China (second preference)**? Please describe up to 3 aspects that attract you to this country.

During my previous visit to Hong Kong in 2024, I was deeply fascinated by the city's atmosphere. On one side the Asian calm and discipline combined with British culture and understatement. The city's cleanliness, structure, and respect for order, combined with its international and English-influenced character, left a lasting impression on me. The great food, huge skyscrapers and welcoming people have made Hong Kong a place I have wanted to return to for a longer time-period ever since. Being able to return to Hong Kong and visit further beautiful and inspiring places in Hong Kong and China mainland would allow me to deepen my understanding of the region's culture, unique history and rapid technological development.

Hong Kong stands out to me as a place where innovation, global business, and cultural diversity come together in a way that exists nowhere else. As a global financial and technological hub with strong ties to both Asia and the Western world, it offers a unique view on how the two major topics of my bachelor's, digitalization and entrepreneurship shape modern economies. Experiencing this first-hand would allow me to understand how growth through technology and digitalization works in one of the most dynamic and innovative regions of the world.

Finally, I believe this environment would make Hong Kong the perfect place for my academic and personal growth. Its educational spirit and universities, especially HKUST, are among Asia's best, combining research with practical solutions. Living and studying in such a fast-paced, dynamic setting would challenge me to step outside my comfort zone and broaden my global view, like no other place could be able to. I would love to make this development and see it as essential for both my academic and personal growth.

6.) Going abroad with TUMexchange means also that you will represent TUM as an **ambassador**. Please describe up to 3 aspects that you would highlight about TUM.

At first, I would highlight that TUM and both UC San Diego as well as HKUST share the same motivation towards combining research-driven innovation and entrepreneurial spirit. TUM, as well as the other two universities, values research that translates into real-world impact. With its close ties to industry, similar as the other two mentioned universities, its own startup incubator, TUM strengthens a culture where students are encouraged to think entrepreneurially and develop new ideas.

TUM is a university for everyone, despite of culture or religion. Here at TUM, as a home to diversity and international community, we value collaboration, openness, and mutual respect for everybody who wants to visit and study abroad at our university. I would highlight TUM's

welcoming and ambitious environment, which motivates students to strive for excellence while remaining curious and responsible in their global engagement. I always remember that Prof. Hofmann told us, speaking at the TUM welcome days, that more than 50% of TUM's master students are not German. For me, this is what lived diversity embedded into our culture at TUM looks like. This is what I am proud to share to my peers abroad.

Moreover, TUM is among the best universities in Europe for studies like computer science, engineering, and management, which is something I would highlight to my peers as well. I would underline the interdisciplinary mindset at TUM, which can be seen in my studies Information Systems, which encourages innovative thinking and prepares students to close the gap between technology and business applications.

B) Academic plan

For University UC San Diego (First Preference)

- 1.) Please explain **why** you have chosen **this university**. (If your chosen university offers a special university program (e.g. GP, SRS) please name it here.)

Firstly, the University of California San Diego is located in the technological heart of the world and the US, California. As birthplace of the most influential technologies of our time, responsible for so many current developments all around the world, California and UC San Diego have to be the first option to choose as an Information Systems student. Apple, Google, Meta, NVIDIA, Tesla, OpenAI and so many more were all founded in California. Qualcomm even directly in San Diego. Experiencing this environment between technology and entrepreneurship with close connection between universities, startups and industry, turning ideas rapidly into innovations, has been my dream for many years. Getting to know this culture would allow me to understand how collaboration, creativity and taking risks drive economic development, which perfectly fits into my Information System studies at TUM and how I can use this valuable knowledge beyond my bachelor's.

The University of California, San Diego is among the world's leading universities in my passions Computer Science, AI and Machine Learning, known for its interdisciplinary approach and strong research orientation. Through the University & Professional Studies (UPS) Program, I would have the unique opportunity to attend regular UC San Diego courses and work with local and international students. This structure allows me to engage directly with the world class faculty of UCSD and gain practical experience through projects. Initiatives like The Basement, which connect ideas of students with UCSD's network, build start-ups with real impact, which perfectly shows this motivation. I would really enjoy learning in these structures to develop into being able to not only know and understand theoretical concepts but apply them in our economy and business world. Maybe these learnings could be the key for me to build up a successful start-up myself.

At last California's unique mix of cultures and ideas creates an inspiring atmosphere. The open-minded way of life, especially regarding technology and entrepreneurship, offers an ideal setting for intellectual and personal development. For me this opportunity is not only a chance to study in world-class environment among some of the brightest people but also to immerse myself in a culture that celebrates innovation and diversity, which are qualities I hope to carry forward in my future academic, professional, and personal life.

2.) Please list your **planned course choices** and how they fit in with your TUM studies.

Throughout my exchange at UC San Diego, I plan to align my studies with TUM's recommended study plan for the 5th semester. I intend to take electives in Economics and Computer Science that are not readily available at TUM to benefit from UC San Diego's strengths and teaching culture. In addition, I plan to take one course that can be recognized toward my module Business Analytics and Machine Learning at TUM.

Economics:

- Quantitative Methods in Business
- AI and Technology Strategy
- Advanced Accounting
- Mergers and Acquisitions

Computer Science:

- Introduction to Artificial Intelligence
- Building and Programming Electronic Devices
- Introduction to Programming Contests
- Deep Learning
- Foundations of Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning

Interdisciplinary (Überfachliche Grundlagen):

- Economics, Politics and International Change
- Culture, Art and Technology
- Negotiations
- Data Ethics

By combining these modules, I aim to fulfill my Computer Science elective (5 ETCS), my Economics elective (6 ETCS) and an equivalent for Business Analytics and Machine Learning in my TUM curriculum. If any issues regarding course enrollment occur, I remain flexible to select other courses within Economics, Computer Science, or Interdisciplinary Studies to complete the remaining 5 ETCS in my plan.

3.) How are you going to plan your studies at TUM around possibly differing **semester times** abroad?

At UC San Diego, the academic term corresponding to TUM's winter semester runs from September to December. This period aligns very well with my studies at TUM. I plan to complete all my exams from my summer semester, which usually end in mid-August, giving me enough time to make final preparations before beginning my exchange in September. When returning to Germany, I will be available to participate in any remaining TUM exams, if there are administrative matters related to credit transfer and course recognition.

For University Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (Second Preference)

1.) Please explain **why** you have chosen **this university**. (If your chosen university offers a special university program (e.g. GP, SRS) please name it here.)

For me the Hong Kong University of Science and Technology is the perfect fit for my semester abroad. Combining world-class research, innovation, and entrepreneurship with the unique flair of Hong Kong, makes the HKUST my choice for personal and academic development

Former HKUST exchange students, whom I have contacted, told me about the amazing, modern campus they were able to experience throughout their stay abroad. For me it is fascinating how Asia, and Hong Kong in particular, advanced and built-up wealth throughout the past centuries. I see it as a huge privilege, being able to learn from these bright minds on how technology and entrepreneurship go hand in hand to build great products for society and economic rise. Something the Hong Kong University of Science and Technology knows more about than probably any other university.

What fascinates me most about the Hong Kong University of Science and Technology is its strong focus on the fields I am most passionate in, technology, innovation and how they can be integrated into products. The university is known for combining research in computer science, business, and data analytics, something which perfectly matches with my curriculum and motivations as an Information Systems student. Its School of Business and Management is consistently ranked among the best in Asia, and the Department of Computer Science and Engineering is internationally recognized for its research in the fields of artificial intelligence and financial technology. For me there is simply no better match in Asia than HKUST, which strengths match my interest perfectly. I am especially impressed by HKUST engagement to connecting students with start-ups and industry partners through initiatives like the Entrepreneurship Center and Hackathon events, which create a culture where ideas are quickly turned into impact. This is exactly what I am looking for in my semester abroad.

2.) Please list your **planned course choices** and how they fit in with your TUM studies.

The Fact sheet states that HKUST advises exchange students to take a total load of 15 credits, with 12 being the minimum and 18 the maximum. Furthermore, HKUST explains that one course usually carries 3 credits. For this reason, I am planning to choose 5 courses out of the courses below (from the link in the TUM Database), remaining flexible if organizational issues regarding course selection occurs. These courses will be two elective courses in Computer Science, one elective course in Economics, one interdisciplinary study (Überfachliche Grundlagen), and one course that is equivalent to the course Business Analytics and Machine Learning at TUM, which perfectly matches my curriculum in Munich.

Economics:

- Software Development with C++ for Quantitative Finance
- Artificial Intelligence for Financial Economics
- Introduction to Econometrics
- International Finance & Open Economy Macro

Computer Science:

- Big Data Mining and Management
- Machine Learning
- Fundamentals of Artificial Intelligence
- Blockchain, Cryptocurrencies and Smart Contracts

Interdisciplinary:

- Artificial Intelligence Ethics
- Business Case Analyses
- The Cantonese Language
- Modern Chinese History

3.) How are you going to plan your studies at TUM around possibly differing **semester times** abroad?

At the University of Hong Kong, the academic term corresponding to TUM's winter semester runs from September until January/February, which largely overlaps with TUM's own winter semester schedule. Therefore, the timing fits very well with my studies at TUM. I plan to complete all my exams from the summer semester in Munich, which usually last until mid-August. This should not be a problem. During my exchange I will focus on my courses at HKUST to make sure that I can transfer the necessary number of credits from HKUST to TUM for my 5th semester.

C) Foreign languages

1.) **ONLY** if you are applying for Universities in Latin America or in Quebec: Please

explain how you are planning to reach the required Spanish/Portuguese/French level for your host university.

2.) **ONLY** if you are applying for countries with a non-European official language (e.g. China or Japan). Even if you are planning to take English-taught courses, **basic knowledge of the language of the host country** can be very useful. Have you been studying that language? Where? And what is your level? Or are you planning to take classes in the language of the host country? Please explain.

I have already gained some basic knowledge of Mandarin through private lessons and during a previous trip to China, where I was able to get a first impression of the language and culture. If I am accepted for an exchange in Hong Kong, I plan to continue studying both Cantonese, the local language in Hong Kong, and Mandarin through language courses offered at "TUM Sprachzentrum" as well as private intensive lessons. My goal is to reach a solid conversational level that allows me to communicate in everyday situations and better understand the local culture. I believe that learning the language is an essential part to make the most out of my exchange.

D) Financing your stay abroad

We would like you to seriously plan in advance, how you can finance your stay abroad. Participation in TUMexchange does not involve any scholarship. How are you going to **finance your stay** abroad? Please note that your financial background does not have an impact on the selection process.

I have already discussed my financial plan with my parents, who will support me during my stay abroad, covering tuition, housing, and everyday costs. In addition, I have saved money over the past years and plan to continue working during the semester breaks to contribute to my expenses. This combination of family support, personal savings, and part-time work ensures that I can finance my semester abroad responsibly.

E) Community engagement

Here you can list ways in which you are actively involved in social activities (e.g. participation in buddy programs, student councils, etc.) which may be important to qualify you for your stay abroad.

I am actively involved as a volunteer language mentor for refugees at Little World gUG, helping them integrate into everyday life in Germany and improve their German skills. Through this role, I have learned how to communicate across cultural and language barriers, listen with empathy and support others in achieving their goals. This experience has strengthened my intercultural understanding and patience, qualities that I consider essential when representing TUM abroad and engaging with people from different backgrounds.

In addition, I have worked as a junior coach at my local tennis club, TC Diedesfeld e.V., where I trained younger players and organized tournaments. This responsibility has helped me develop leadership, teamwork and organizational skills.

Moreover, I contribute to the EveryNameCounts initiative, a digital memorial project dedicated to preserving the stories of victims of National Socialism. Participating in this project has deepened my awareness of historical backgrounds, which I see as very important when being a respectful student abroad in a new culture.

Together, these activities show my commitment to community involvement, intercultural understanding and using technology for social good. These are the values that I aim to bring to my exchange semester and represent as a TUM ambassador abroad.